

IN THE VORTEX Former additonal chief secretary Subodh Agarwal in custody

THE NATION
RAJASTHAN

A LEAKY PIPELINE

FORGED TENDERS, INFLATED CONTRACTS AND ENTRENCHED INTERESTS CONVERGE IN A ₹979-CRORE SCAM IN THE STATE'S JAL JEEVAN SCHEME

By ROHIT PARIHAR

ON June 4, the Rajasthan Anti-Corruption Bureau (ACB) filed a 17,500-page chargesheet against Subodh Agarwal, a retired IAS officer and former additional chief secretary of the public health engineering department (PHED), opening the floodgates on a major corruption case. Agarwal headed the department implementing Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) schemes from April 2022 to January 2024. Investigators allege that during this period, two firms—M/s Shri Ganpati Tubewell Company and M/s Shree Shyam Tubewell Company—won contracts worth Rs 979 crore between 2021 and 2023 using forged documents, with the active col-